

08 — Transcription & Captioning

Audio → text · Subtitles · Rev · GoTranscript · Freelance · 2026

■0 capital · Laptop preferred · Fast accurate typing + good English

How to earn by converting audio and video into accurate text or time-synced captions. Covers platform work (Rev, GoTranscript, TranscribeMe), direct freelance gigs, realistic rates and the setup that works for Nigerians.

1. What This Hustle Is

You listen to audio or watch video and type what is said (transcription) or create timed subtitles/captions. Clients include content creators, researchers, podcasters, companies needing accessibility, and AI data projects. Work is paid per audio minute or per project. Strong listening skills, accurate typing and attention to speaker labels/formatting matter most. No degree required. Speed + accuracy determines effective hourly rate.

2. Realistic Earnings 2026

Level / Type	Typical rate	Effective hourly	Monthly (part-time)
Platform beginner	\$0.30–\$0.60 / audio min	\$8–\$15	■80k–■250k
Platform intermediate	\$0.50–\$1.00 / min	\$12–\$22	■200k–■500k
Freelance / specialist	\$0.75–\$1.50+ / min	\$18–\$35+	■300k–■800k+

Captioning often pays higher than pure transcription. Medical/legal specialisation pays more but needs extra knowledge. Platform work is easiest to start; direct freelance clients pay better once you have samples and reviews. Payoneer/Grey essential for most platforms.

3. Best Platforms & Paths for Nigerians

- GoTranscript — relatively accessible, consistent volume
- TranscribeMe — good for beginners, team options
- Rev — higher rates possible, stricter quality + occasional waitlist
- Upwork / Fiverr — set your own rates for podcasts, YouTube, research
- Direct outreach to Nigerian creators and agencies who need captions
- AI data / language projects (Hausa, Igbo, Yoruba, Nigerian English) when available

4. Exact Setup (■0)

- Reliable laptop or desktop preferred (phone is painful for long files)
- Good headset or earbuds + quiet environment
- Free tools: oTranscribe, Express Scribe (free), Google Docs voice typing for practice
- Payoneer or Grey for platform payouts; Nigerian bank for local clients
- Practice typing speed (aim 60+ WPM) and accuracy with free online tests

5. 14-Day Starter Path

Days 1–4: Practice transcription of free podcasts. Improve speed and speaker labeling. Open Payoneer.

Days 5–8: Apply to GoTranscript + TranscribeMe (and Rev if open). Create simple Fiverr gig for “podcast transcription”.

Days 9–14: Complete first platform jobs carefully. Collect samples. Send 5–10 outreach messages to local creators needing captions.

6. Pricing & Quality Rules

- Never rush accuracy — rejected files waste time and damage platform standing.
- For freelance: start around \$0.80–\$1.20 per audio minute for clean general work.
- Always clarify format (verbatim vs clean read), speaker labels, and turnaround.
- Captioning: learn basic timing and accessibility standards for higher rates.

7. Common Mistakes

- Applying to strict platforms first without practice samples.
- Ignoring style guides — platforms reject for small formatting errors.
- Working only on noisy audio without proper tools or patience.
- Underpricing freelance work and accepting unlimited revisions.

8. Action Checklist

- Typing speed tested and practice files completed
- Payoneer/Grey opened
- Accounts created on 1–2 platforms + Fiverr/Upwork profile
- Quiet workspace + headset ready
- First paid job delivered carefully

Companion resources in matching JSON. FinReels Online Hustle package.
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